

The White battery

By C.G.S.Narayanan

A white battery is one formation of white men which can deliver a number of discovered checks which lead to mate. The white battery has two components- a frontal piece which discovers the check and a rear piece, always a line piece, which actually checks the black king. Batteries can be either diagonal or lateral. When the frontal piece is the king it is known as a Royal battery. The nomenclature of the battery is expressed in the order of rear and frontal piece. In the first example by the British Grandmaster who was one of the great exponents of battery play, it is the B+R battery on the long diagonal h1-a8 which fires on all cylinders contributing to six of the eight mates of the black knight wheel.

Comins Mansfield
Morning Post 1933



Mate in two moves

Every move of the BN is provided with a mate in the diagram above. **The key 1.Rh7!** cleverly changes mates for 1...Nxf6 with 2.Rg6 now white pinning the BN. This is a 'mutate' which changes one or more mates in a complete block setting. The second is an evergreen masterpiece which combines battery

play with three-line play. Three line pieces- BQa8, BRa6 and BRa5 attack the R+B battery. WRe3 leaves the third rank to threaten 2.Qf3. There are two tries (near keys) and a key which shuts off one of the three black lines.

Alex Casa & Dr. Werner Speckmann

III prize, Die Schwalbe 1954



Mate in two moves

1.Re6? (2.Qf3) 1...Nc5/Nd8 2.Bf8/Be5 but 1...Nd6! Refutes. 1.Re8? (2.Qf3) 1...Nc5/Nd6 2.Bf6/Be5 but 1...Nd8!

Key 1.Re5! (2.Qf3) 1...Nd8/Nd6/Nc5 2.Bf6/Bf8/Rg5.

The problem for solving below combines battery with cross-check.

Albert Volkmann

Die Schwalbe 1954



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Black interference': Key 1.Qc7! Eight interferences are: 1...Bb7 2.Nxb6 1...Rb7 2.Qc6; 1...Bg3 2.Bb3; 1...Rf4 2.Qxe5; 1...Bf4 2.Be4; 1...Rg4 2.Qd7 1...d3 2.Nc3; 1...e4 2.Rxd4

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